

Weather Notes

Short observations for curious readers

Contents

Preface 1

Chapter 1 Rain 2

Chapter 2 Wind 4

Preface

These notes began as a notebook kept on a windowsill. Every morning the sky looked a little different, and writing it down turned a habit into a small study.

Nothing here needs special instruments. A glass jar, a ribbon and a patient eye are enough to start.

Chapter 1

Rain

Rain is water that has travelled a long way. It rose as vapour from seas and fields, cooled high in the air, and gathered into drops heavy enough to fall.

Where rain comes from

Warm air holds more moisture than cold air. When warm, damp air is pushed upward by a hill or by a colder air mass, it cools,

and the moisture it can no longer hold becomes cloud and then rain.

Measuring rain

A straight-sided jar left in an open place collects rain at the same depth as the ground around it. Measuring that depth each morning gives a simple record of how wet the day was.

Chapter 2

Wind

A ribbon tied to a stick is the easiest wind gauge. When it hangs down, the air is calm; when it streams straight out, the wind is strong enough to notice on the face.

Keeping the same stick in the same place matters more than the stick itself. Comparisons only make sense when the conditions stay the same.